



Along the river

The soil along a riverbank is rich in nutrients deposited by flooding, so plants here can grow large and often very fast. They can thrive all summer long, as they never suffer drought. However, when a river floods, the fast-flowing water may carry away anything not firmly rooted in the soil.

Swamp rose mallow



Each large flower grows to about 6 in (15 cm) across.

Brilliant yellow flowers attract bees in early spring.



Marsh marigold

Tiny, brown female flowers grow in the form of a dense spike.

Giant rhubarb

These huge leaves have a spiny underside that stops animals from eating them.

Cattail

GIANT LEAVES

Native to riverbanks in Brazil, the giant rhubarb has massive leaves—the largest undivided leaves of any flowering plant. Its flowers, however, are tiny and grow on spiky heads near the ground.

